



THOSE WHO UNTIL NOW HAVE BEEN MERCENARIES FOR A FEW COINS ACHIEVE ETERNAL REWARDS

THE FALL OF JERUSALEM (1099)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

The Crusades

BEFORE

639 A Muslim army captures Jerusalem.

1009 Caliph al-Hakim orders Jerusalem's Church of the Holy Sepulchre to be destroyed.

1071 Seljuk Turks defeat and capture Byzantine emperor, Romanus Diogenes.

1095 Byzantine emperor Alexios sends to pope for help.

AFTER

1120 The Order of the Knights Templar is founded.

1145 The Second Crusade is launched.

1187 Muslim leader Saladin captures Jerusalem, and the Third Crusade is launched.

1198 Baltic Crusade begins.

1291 Muslim forces complete the reconquest of Palestine and Syria.



Victorious crusaders flooded into Jerusalem, and in a ruthless assault seized the city from the Fatimid caliphate, laying the foundations for a new kingdom.

of 200 years of Muslim–Christian warfare in the Holy Land.

Defending Christianity

Jerusalem had fallen into Muslim hands in 639. Neither the Byzantine emperors in Constantinople nor the Christian kings in Western Europe had the political willpower or the strength to reverse the conquest, although the city was sacred to both.

In the 11th century, however, the advances of a new group, the Seljuk Turks, disrupted the pilgrimage routes to Jerusalem, and the Turks' defeat of the Byzantines at Manzikert threatened to push the frontiers of Christianity back to the gates of Constantinople. In 1095, Emperor Alexios I Komnenos sent emissaries to Pope Urban II asking for help to bolster the Byzantine retaliation.

On July 15, 1099, some 15,000 Christian knights surged into Jerusalem after a month-long siege. The victorious crusaders slaughtered Muslim defenders and Jews alike in a bloody act that marked the beginning